EXPERIMENT 02

Setting up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring Platform Architecture and Interface

Low Code Application Development using Zoho Creator

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1. Aim

To set up a Zoho Creator account, explore the platform architecture and user interface, understand core components like dashboards, application creation options, microservices, environments, portals, governance, and billing.

2. Platform Architecture

The Zoho Creator platform architecture is structured across multiple integrated layers:
• **End Users:** Access applications via web browsers, mobile apps (Android/iOS), or external portals.
• **Zoho Creator Platform:** The core development environment comprising Application Development, Reports & Dashboards, Workflows & Automation, Deluge Scripting, Security & Access Management, and Developer Tools.
• **Data Management:** Secure database storage, file attachments, and data caching.
• **Integrations:** Connects with Zoho apps (CRM, Books, Desk) and third-party REST APIs and services.
• **Cloud Infrastructure:** Runs on Zoho Cloud providing scalable servers, data encryption, automated backups, and high availability.

3. Dashboard & Interface Exploration

The Dashboard serves as the central control panel and home screen upon logging into Zoho Creator. It displays recently used applications, allows organizing apps into folders, provides account settings, and enables quick access to create and manage forms, reports, and workflows.

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4. Application Creation & Microservices

Create New Application Options:

• *Create using Zia:* Uses AI assistant to build apps automatically from requirements.
• *Create from Scratch:* Custom application building from the ground up.
• *Create from Gallery:* Ready-made templates customizable for business needs.
• *Import from File:* Creates applications by importing existing data from Excel or CSV.

Microservices: Extend application capabilities with AI Models, AR Library, Third-party Connections, External Datasources, and Custom APIs.

5. Deployment, Portals & Governance

• **Environments:** Separates development into Development, Stage (testing), and Production (live) environments.
• **Portals:** Secure login portals for external users (customers, vendors, partners) without requiring full Zoho Creator accounts.
• **Users & Governance:** Role-based access control (Admin, Developer, User), security policies, and activity monitoring.
• **Metrics & Operations:** Performance tracking, system logs, data backup/recovery, and billing management.

6. Conclusion

Successfully explored the Zoho Creator platform architecture, dashboard interface, application creation methods, environments, and administrative tools, demonstrating a thorough understanding of the platform's enterprise capabilities.

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